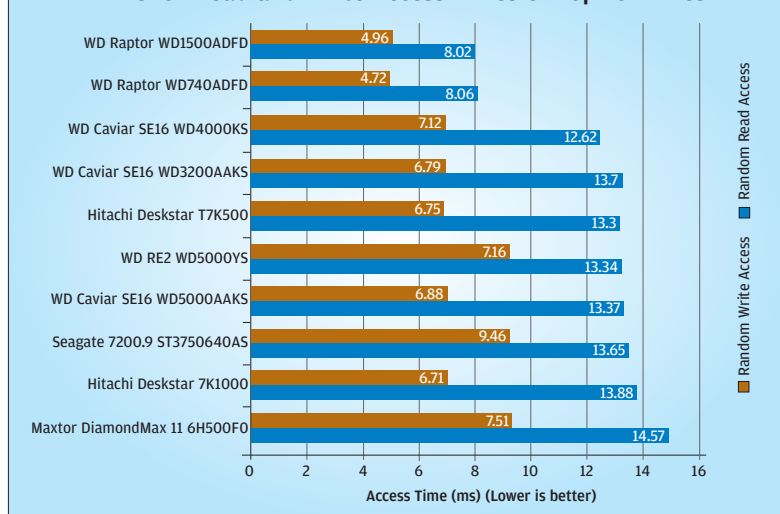


H2Bench Read and Write Access Times Of Top 10 Drives



in the drive, and clocked the scores. This test simulated a real-world file transfer. We transfer files such as songs, movies, documents, and programs every day from one hard drive to another or from one partition to another. This test brings out exactly how well these drives perform in these routine activities.

To a large extent, the drives did match up to their synthetic test performance results. The WD Raptors scored well in almost every file transfer test, but there were others such as the Seagate

750 GB and the Maxtor DiamondMax 11 that did not disappoint either.

Internal transfer is the most stressful of all the file transfer tests, so a drive that excels in these is a real performer. As we'd expected, the WD Raptors, owing to their faster rpm and lower access times were the clear winners in the internal assorted file transfer test, taking just around two and a quarter minutes to complete. In the internal sequential file transfer test, the Seagate 750 GB took just over two minutes, followed by the both the Raptors and the Maxtor DiamondMax 11, each lagging by just a few seconds.

Application Loading: Photoshop CS2 And Far Cry

Here we noted the time required to open Adobe Photoshop CS2 with the scratch disk configured to be on the test drive, and we were completely taken by surprise. Two Samsung drives (300 GB and 400 GB) loaded Photoshop faster than the rest, even though the difference was just around a second. We then opened the 550 GB and 1 GB PSD files that were present on the test hard drive. The Western Digital Caviar SE16 drives as well as the WD RE2 WD5000YS were found to be the top three performers here. The slowest drives were the 400 GB drives from Seagate and Samsung, trailing by at least 15 seconds.

We then opened the 1 GB file, and the 74 GB Raptor returned to top position—to which

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